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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, BAHRAIN KING DISCUSS REGIONAL DEVELOPMENTS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received King Hamad Bin Eisa Al Khalifa of Bahrain during his visit to the UAE. The leaders reviewed regional and international issues of shared interest, including developments in the Middle East and ongoing efforts to strengthen security and stability for the benefit of all countries and peoples of the region. Both sides expressed pride in the deep-rooted ties between the UAE and Bahrain and reaffirmed their commitment to further strengthening cooperation, particularly in light of the shared challenges the region is facing and the need for close coordination and cooperation.

IN FOCUS

Drought dries major European rivers to record lows

Europe bakes under its warmest ever early summer | P8-9



Tata Sons chairman to step down

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Tata Sons chairman N. Chandrasekaran, 63, said yesterday he would not seek reappointment when his term ends next year, deepening a leadership crisis at India's largest conglomerate.

Chandrasekaran's proposed third term as Tata Sons chairman became caught in disagreements over capital spending, losses at newer businesses and whether the holding company could remain private.

The Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and Sir Ratan Tata Trust had unanimously recommended extending his tenure by five years, while Tata Sons' Nomination and Remuneration Committee had also recommended the proposal. Yet it failed to secure unanimous support when tabled at the Tata Sons board meeting on February 24.

SEE ALSO P-III



Emirates, Etihad rank among Middle East's top 3 airlines

Emirates wins premium economy while Etihad among top airlines for passenger trust

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Emirates has been voted the preferred airline in the Middle East and Africa in the 2026 Flyers' Choice Awards, while Etihad Airways took third place in the regional ranking.

The awards, organised by AirlineRatings.com, are based entirely on traveller votes and echo passenger preferences across cabin classes, service, trust and regional airline performance.

Qatar Airways ranked second in the Middle East and Africa category, placing the three Gulf carriers at the top of the regional table.

Emirates also performed strongly in several individual categories, taking first place for Preferred Premium Economy.

The Dubai airline ranked second in Preferred Business Class behind Qatar Airways



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and second in Preferred Economy behind Singapore Airlines.

Preferred choice

Passengers also placed Emirates second for Best Cabin Crew, while Etihad ranked third in the same category.

Etihad also ranked among the airlines passengers associated most strongly with confidence and peace of mind.

The Abu Dhabi carrier placed third in the Peace of Mind category, behind Singapore Airlines

WE OWN HORMUZ, SAYS TRUMP BUT SHIP TRAFFIC FALLS

Just 8 vessels tracked in strait against 130-140 before war

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump declared yesterday that America has "total control" of the Strait of Hormuz and intends to "keep it" — even as shipping through the vital waterway plunged to a fraction of pre-war levels and oil prices continued to rise.

"The U.S.A. has total control over the Strait of Hormuz. I THINK WE WILL KEEP IT!" Trump wrote on Truth Social.

He described the US naval blockade as a "WALL OF STEEL" and said there was "nothing Iran can do about it".

The declaration reinforced comments Trump made late Tuesday when he told reporters: "We have total control over the Hormuz Strait right now. They don't have control. We have total control. We own it."

But conditions at sea present a more complicated picture.

Only eight vessels were tracked in Hormuz on Tuesday, according to Kpler data — the lowest daily tally in a week and dramatically below the 130 to 140 ships that typically crossed each day before the war.

Of the seven vessels entering the strait, all took the Iranian route. Separate LSEG data recorded 11 transits, down from 14 the previous day.

Oil rises as uncertainty deepens

Energy markets are also signalling continuing concern.

Brent crude climbed above \$89 a barrel in London yesterday, extending its rally into a sixth day as traders weighed fading prospects for a settlement.

The danger extends beyond Hormuz. Yemeni authorities said six people were killed on Tuesday when the Iran-backed Houthis fired three ballistic missiles at a commercial vessel in the Bab Al Mandeb strait — the first known shipping deaths in the latest escalation.

US Central Command said American forces fired on a Panama-flagged cargo vessel heading towards Iran on Tuesday after it allegedly violated Washington's blockade, disabling its steering.

Pakistan's Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi, meanwhile, travelled to Iran carrying a message from Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif and army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir to the Iranian leadership.

SEE ALSO P6

NATION

UAE leaders hail role of youth in country's growth | P4

BUSINESS

How Spinneys rewired its food supply network amid shipping crisis | P-11

NATION

Meet the man behind Sharjah's Pakistan Chowk | P3



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Ronaldo marries Georgina in a private civil ceremony

Couple's five children join the celebration

DUBAI

BY JAI RAI
Special to Gulf News

Cristiano Ronaldo and Georgina Rodriguez tied the knot on Tuesday. The Portuguese football superstar, 41, married his longtime partner in a private civil ceremony in Cascais, Portugal.

The couple confirmed the news in a joint social media post on Tuesday evening, sharing a photo of their hands showing off matching gold wedding bands. Ronaldo captioned the post simply: "CheartG".

The ceremony was described as a "private and intimate moment" attended by the couple's five children.

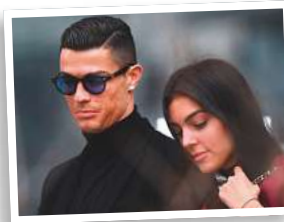
One year later

The wedding comes exactly one year after Georgina, 32, announced their engagement on social media on August 11 last year. She shared a picture of her hand resting on Ronaldo's, giving fans a glimpse of her large oval-shaped diamond ring.

"Sí, quiero. En esta y en todas mis vidas," Georgina

wrote at the time, which translates to, "Yes, I do. In this and in all my lives."

Ronaldo and Georgina are parents to five children: twins Eva Maria and Mateo, 9, daughter Alana, 8, daughter Bella, 4, and Cristiano Jr., 16, whom Ronaldo welcomed from a previous relationship.



Georgina is a Spanish model, influencer, dancer and businesswoman. She developed a passion for dance from a young age and trained as a ballerina before eventually moving into the fashion industry. In Madrid, she worked as a luxury sales assistant, including at Gucci, where she met Ronaldo.

■ Jai Rai is a seasoned sports journalist based in the UAE.

SEE ALSO P12, 15